

TENNIS

Indian contingent



Sumit Nagal (Men's Singles), **Yuki Bhambri and Dhakshineswar Suresh** (Men's Doubles Team 1), **Anirudh Chandrasekar and N. Sriram Balaji** (Men's Doubles Team 2), **Ankita Raina and Rutuja Bhosale** (Women's Doubles)

TOTAL MEDALS AT STAKE

20

MEN'S
DOUBLES

YUKI BHAMBRI AND DHAKSHINESWAR SURESH

While India has decided to field two pairs in the men's doubles competition and the combined ranking of N. Sriram Balaji and Anirudh Chandrasekar is better, Yuki Bhambri and Dhakshineswar Suresh will be one of the favourites for the gold medal.

The 34-year-old Yuki is the only Asian player in the ATP Top 50 in doubles. Once a bright prospect in singles, he has smoothly transitioned to doubles and is now consistently playing at the Majors.

In the 26-year-old Dhakshineswar, he has a 6'5" tall partner who can serve big in crucial moments. The duo played together for the first time during this year's Davis Cup Qualifiers Round 1 in Bengaluru where they won a three-hour thriller against the experienced Dutch duo of Sander Arends and David Pel.

Yuki already has an Asian Games doubles medal — a bronze with Divij Sharan from Incheon (2014). Twelve years later, with a more well-rounded doubles game and a powerful partner in Dhakshineswar, he can go all the way on the hard courts in Aichi-Nagoya.

K. MURALI KUMAR

